

Interest Group Annual Report

Darwin Core

Web Site: <https://www.tdwg.org/community/dwc/>

Convener(s):	
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Phase of work:

As the Interest Group is a Maintenance Group, we are entirely in a maintenance phase, where the goal is to respond to community demand to improve the standard.

Activities:

- The core group manages activities mostly using GitHub issues and their comments. At times private email discussions supplement this when there are discussions about how best to accomplish something, or to strategize on making progress. These do not enter the public record.
- Some of the activity took place immediately following the last annual meeting of TDWG, but the majority of the effort began in July 2020 and remains a high priority at present
- All activities conducted by the Maintenance Group were voluntary.
- By far the most important accomplishment during the year was the alignment of Darwin Core to the Standards Documentation Specification (SDS) and the beginning of management of Darwin Core within the specification under the processes defined under the Vocabulary Maintenance Standard (VMS).
- Once the alignment with standards was done, we reviewed all of the more than 150 open issues, closed 67 of them, and prioritized the remaining issues by their state of maturity and readiness to be dealt with in a timely way.
- As a result of the general cleanup of issues above, the process of tackling the backlog of pending term addition and change requests was begun, resulting in the successful promotion of the most mature of these (dealing with alien and invasive species) through the ratification process.

- Support of Darwin Core has continued by actively responding to issues raised via the Darwin Core Questions & Answers GitHub repository, and by producing additional documentation as a result of the discussions that arise there.
- The Maintenance Group has been heavily involved in the Chronometric Age Task Group under the Environmental Samples and Paleobiology Interest Group, as one of the objectives of that task group is to create a ratified extension to Darwin Core that can facilitate the publication of these types of data via Darwin Core Archives.

Accomplishments:

- Groom Q, Desmet P, Reyserhove L, Adriaens T, Oldoni D, Vanderhoeven S, Baskauf SJ, Chapman A, McGeoch M, Walls R, Wieczorek J, Wilson JR.U, Zermoglio PFF, Simpson A. 2019. Improving Darwin Core for research and management of alien species. Biodiversity Information Science and Standards 3: e38084.

Impediments to progress:

- Lack of funding translates into lack of time that can be prioritized to support the activities of the Maintenance Group.
- Not having an in-person working group meeting at the Annual Meeting. Little work was actually accomplished in the online replacement to this meeting, though it was very good for educating the community where we stand and how the process works.

Changes in goals or scope

Now that the standard and web site have been updated to conform with TDWG standards and norms of presentation and maintenance, we will concentrate on annual releases of the standard rather than the ad-hoc schedule that has been followed up to now.

Plans for next calendar year

- Prepare documentation to reflect recently ratified new terms, new vocabularies, and term change. (2020-11)
- Evaluate the remaining new term and term change requests. (2020-11)
- Make a new release of the standard when all term additions and changes that are mature have gone through ratification. (2020-12)
- Assist with the implementation of updated Darwin Core Archive extension definitions that reflect ratified changes. (2020-12)
- Evaluate the open non-term issues related to documentation. (2021-01)
- Continue to support community use of the standard through the Darwin Core Question & Answers site and solicited consultations. (Ongoing)